

ENDEMIC HOT SPOTS

Scientists have shown that these regions have the greatest number of plant species living only within a small area. They call these species "endemic" to that area. In these hot spots of unique plants, scientists tend to find lots of endemic animals, too.

 Region rich in endemic species

BIOMES

 Tropical dry broad-leaved forest

 Tropical coniferous forest

 Temperate broad-leaved forest

 Temperate coniferous forest

 Tropical moist broad-leaved forest

 Boreal forest

 Savanna

 Flooded savanna

 Steppe

 Mountain grasslands and shrublands

 Mediterranean shrublands

 Desert and dry shrublands

 Arctic tundra

 Polar desert

 Mangroves

Mountains of southwest China

Each ridge of mountains has its own distinct wildlife. Endangered species, such as the Yunnan snub-nosed monkey, live only here.

Philippines

Of this country's 1,000 types of orchids, 70 percent grow nowhere else.

Wallacea

This region is named after 19th-century naturalist Alfred Russel Wallace, who noticed its unique wildlife such as the piglike babirusa.

New Guinea

This large island is home to many unique birds of paradise and several endemic tree kangaroos, including this species, the ursine tree kangaroo.

East Melanesia

This string of islands has 3,000 endemic plant species and spectacular birdwing and swallowtail butterflies. This is a Ulysses swallowtail.

Eastern Mediterranean

The Cedar of Lebanon lives only in a small area, including Lebanon, Israel, Palestine, and parts of Syria, Jordan, and Turkey.

Ethiopian Highlands

These highlands are home to 30 endemic bird species and the endangered Ethiopian wolf.

Madagascar

Ninety-eight percent of Madagascar's land mammals, 92 percent of its reptiles, 68 percent of its plants, and 41 percent of its breeding bird species exist nowhere else on Earth. All 16 mantella frogs are also endemic to the island.

East African Highlands

These islands of high ground in a sea of savanna support unusual plants such as this giant lobelia that grows on the slopes of Mount Kenya and Kilimanjaro.

Cape region

This is a small area of amazingly distinctive plantlife, including 6,000 endemic species such as this pincushion protea.

Sri Lanka and Western Ghats

This hot spot is home to 5,000 species of flowering plants, 139 mammal species, 508 birds, and 179 amphibian species.

Sundaland

Naturalists outline this region because its wildlife is distinct from next-door regions. One bizarre plant unique to Sundaland is *Rafflesia*, the stinking corpse lily.

Western Australia

Like the South African Cape region, this is a "habitat island" of Mediterranean-type shrubland, full of plants found nowhere else, including the odd "kangaroo paw."

New Caledonia

Nothing like the strange, flightless kagu bird is found anywhere else in the world.